THE ONLY THING THAT CARRIES WEIGHT

SELECTED POEMS 2009–2019

Blue Note

Natural disasters and the ways to stay safe.

Prepared for the worst, but the worst is always so unexpected.

The rain falls and it seems to be so out of the blue.

It's the blue that surrounds us.
The blue that engulfs us.
The blue that becomes us.

Blue.

Disasters.
Dreams.

Blue.

Fate.

Blue.

Love.

Blue.

This Is Water

Twenty-six years old as I descend into the darkness. A spiritual cancer. Poor self-image. What is this positive image of self? At times it feels like waiting for the end.

It seems more than anything else what has defeated me is this anxiety. Constant conscious anxiety. Is this water? Struggling simply to bring myself to the table. Struggling to look people in the eyes. Struggling to share myself with others.

It's just down down down and you're stuck in it and down down down.

I've always come out on the other side I guess, but when you're in it you're in it. There is no perspective. No point of reference or scale. A pain with infinite depth.

It is total.

I hide from it.
I hide in it.
I hide.

I die every time I fall asleep and with that comes peace and awaken in hell.

A hell of little anxious terrors. Constantly digging. A pain becoming part of who I am.

From life as I know it this pain seems the essential defining component of my human experience.

Perhaps it's just the latter part. I suppose that's possible.

Perhaps we can feel pain from a place of peace.

In the Ashes...

Evolution.

Creation through destruction.
Through the fires of time.

Truth.

Or simply a desire to watch it all burn.

Repetition

It does seem so repetitive at times.

These cycles that you know completely and absolutely, yet are new and surprising every fucking time.

It is beyond belief, but I find this happening. Happening anew and intriguing me.

I am curious.

What is behind door number 3?

Hmm...

Denial is a basic human defense mechanism. It's so fucking instinctive. I suppose in a better light it's seen as hope or faith, but all of these come from the same place I think.

Forgiveness.

Hmm…

A clean slate.

To make the same mistakes.

Hmm, what a peculiar one.

A mistake does not exist until the endeavor has gone pear-shaped.

Should not we explore the great known?

I still feel as if I should know better, but I am.

Cyclical. Repetitive.

Fucking repetitive arguments.
Fucking repetitive lives.

It comes to me in frustration or anger I suppose, but I feel at peace.

Bempatine

Deliver us from evil as evil consumes us.

As we burn.

For glory...

Bempatine.

As we pour on the gasoline.

Bempatine.

As we embrace our sweetest dream.

Is it still a problem if you know it's a problem.

Is addiction only for the addicts...

As we consume ourselves.

Untitled

The ability to write when sober...

The ability to transcend all of this in our art...

The ability to live through...

The love our addiction feeds back to us

The comforts we feel in its warm embrace.

The future it promises us....

The path forward we see within its stars

Make us free

Make us new

Make us

Addiction

It feels like there is this weight building up or pressure. When I was first thinking about it I thought of it as a cup filling up but perhaps it's pressure.

A pressure that builds and builds with thoughts becoming not unclear but denser.

It is not that it feels like the only thing in my mind.

It is that it feels like the only thing that carries weight.

The only thing that is calling.

The only voice worth listening to.

I always describe the feeling post-binge with positivity, but it isn't positive in the sense of happiness.

It is simply a clarity.

Everything in its right place.

Everything back into balance.

The tranquility of empty silence after the storm.

There is a point between the peak of binging and this silence that is truly devastating.

It feels like being in hospice or something where one is unable to control basic human functions.

It's troubling. It's cause for concern.

I find myself with anxiety, depression, panic attacks and difficult thoughts.

It's brutal.

Lost in the storm with no hope of return.

I do return though.

Whole?

I don't know.

Is this part of my process a natural ebb and flow or is this slowly destroying me?

What is addiction?

Perhaps this is some sort of compulsion to feel.

Perhaps there is little distinction between whether something is positive or negative.

Simply the desire to feel.

Something.

Anything that touches you deeply.

Love or the other side of that something that touches to the soul.

The chaos of this post-binge seems to touch deeply.

To the soul.

Burns to the soul.

But to the soul nonetheless...

The Knife's Edge Sinks Deeper.

Further into the depths of addiction.

Terror engulfs us.

As it bleeds into us...

As it takes over...

We welcome the familiar taste.

We are one.

We are magnificent.

Dealer's Choice

Sometimes it feels like I've got no choice in the matter.

Its warm embrace.

We ease into the choices that make us.

Neon Lights

Not a day goes by...

... The invitation.